Reading and writing

2026-10-16 | Week 1 | People solve problems

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D

3.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the sequence of events, the conflict, and the resolution. In plain English: Explain the order of story events, the problem and how it is solved. 3.7D: Retell and paraphrase texts in ways that maintain meaning and logical order. In plain English: Retell or put a text into your own words while keeping its meaning and order. Today: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C

4.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution. In plain English: Explain how a story builds to its turning point and moves toward a solution. 4.7C: Use text evidence to support an appropriate response. In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows. Today: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot.

I Do

Read a short, accessible scene from Room on the Broom. Show a visual sequence strip: beginning, middle, end. Ask the shared WH question, "Who is here, where are they, and what happens first?" Model pointing to a picture, choosing an answer card, using AAC or dictating a sentence. Then connect the same scene to each learner's target: Grade 3 identify the story problem and the action a character takes.; Grade 4 explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot..

We Do

Reread the same scene aloud. Both learners use the same book, illustrations and three-part sequence mat. Ask who, what, where, when, why and how questions about the beginning, middle and end. Grade 3 arranges picture cards and answers with pointing, speech, AAC or dictation. Grade 4 explains the event, character action or evidence using the same page. Fade the model, switch teacher rotations, then revisit the visual sequence.

You Do

Use one fresh WH question about Room on the Broom: "What happened at the beginning, middle or end, and how do you know?" Grade 3: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. Grade 4: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. Record the page or illustration, response mode, prompt level and whether the student identified the story-structure element.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: The learner not with the teacher uses a previously taught three-picture sequence, WH picture sort, character/setting match or known Vizzle task from Room on the Broom. When finished, the learner may complete the week's book craft or quiet enrichment. The teacher then switches and teaches the other learner from the same scene.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Real books: Room on the Broom. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

After the shared read-aloud and comprehension sequence, each learner makes an individual response from the same book. Grade 3: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. Grade 4: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. Offer large primary writing lines, a picture-to-sentence frame, tracing, dictation or AAC. Record composition separately from oral or picture evidence.

Visual WH and story-structure routine

Use the same book for both learners. Show who, what, where, when, why and how picture cards. Ask about the beginning, middle and end. Arrange three scene cards, then let each learner answer with pointing, AAC, speech, dictation or writing. Record the response mode and prompt level.

Craft or enrichment after comprehension

After comprehension, offer a simple book-connected craft: make a beginning-middle-end mini-book, build a character or setting collage, act out the problem and solution with props, or illustrate the favorite scene. Keep the visual sequence available and treat the craft as enrichment, not a replacement for the comprehension response.

8-9 AM read-aloud

Room on the Broom by Julia Donaldson. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

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Grade 3 | TEKS 3.4H, 3.4J

3.4H: Determine the number of objects in each group when a set of objects is partitioned into equal shares or a set of objects is shared equally. In plain English: Find how many objects are in each group after sharing equally. 3.4J: Determine a quotient using the relationship between multiplication and division. In plain English: Use a related multiplication fact to solve a division problem. Today: Share 6 counters between 2 plates, then show how many are in each group.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.4E, 4.4F

4.4E: Represent the quotient of up to a four-digit whole number divided by a one-digit whole number using arrays, area models, or equations. In plain English: Model division of up to a four-digit number by a one-digit number. 4.4F: Use strategies and algorithms, including the standard algorithm, to divide up to a four-digit dividend by a one-digit divisor. In plain English: Use division strategies and the standard algorithm with up to four-digit dividends and one-digit divisors. Today: Build a fresh equal-sharing example and identify the quotient.

I Do

Grade 3: Share 8 counters between 2 plates; each plate receives 4. Connect the model to 8 / 2 = 4. Grade 4: Share 12 counters among 3 cups; connect 4 in each cup to 12 / 3 = 4.

We Do

Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations. Grade 3: after sharing 8 into 2 equal groups, use 2 x 4 = 8 to explain why 8 / 2 = 4. Grade 4: connect 12 / 3 to the written division algorithm: divide 12 ones into 3 groups, write 4, multiply 4 x 3, subtract 12, and show remainder 0. Extend with place-value blocks to 132 / 3 = 44 when ready; preserve the same place-value steps.

You Do

Grade 3: Share 6 counters between 2 plates, then show how many are in each group. Grade 4: Build a fresh equal-sharing example and identify the quotient.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention.

Science

2026-10-16 | Week 1 | People solve problems

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.7A, 3.7B

3.7A: Demonstrate and describe forces acting on an object in contact or at a distance, including magnetism, gravity, and pushes and pulls. In plain English: Show and explain pushes, pulls, gravity and magnetism, including forces that act without touching. 3.7B: Plan and conduct a descriptive investigation to demonstrate and explain how position and motion can be changed by pushing and pulling objects such as swings, balls, and wagons. In plain English: Plan and carry out a test showing how pushes and pulls change position or motion. Today: Show how a push or pull changes motion.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.6B, 4.6C

4.6B: Investigate and compare a variety of mixtures, including solutions that are composed of liquids in liquids and solids in liquids. In plain English: Investigate and compare mixtures, including liquids mixed with liquids and solids with liquids. 4.6C: Demonstrate that matter is conserved when mixtures such as soil and water or oil and water are formed. In plain English: Show that matter is still present when materials are combined into a mixture. Today: Compare a mixture and a solution; use before/after mass readings of the same closed container to show that matter is conserved.

I Do

Grade 3: Use a toy car to model a push and pull; contact can change an object's motion. Grade 4: Mix dry beans with large pasta, then separate them. Mix sugar into water and observe that it is still present even when not visible. For conservation, weigh a lidded clear container holding separate soil and water before mixing. Mix without opening or spilling, then weigh the same closed system again. Compare readings; the materials remain even though their arrangement changes.

We Do

Predict with objects or pictures, test together, then identify what changed. Keep one test variable different and other relevant conditions the same. Grade 4 repeats the closed-container before/after weighing and records both readings. Compare a soil-water mixture with a sugar-water solution and a liquid-liquid mixture such as oil and water. Do not taste the materials. Grade 3 chooses a push or pull to test, predicts the position change, marks the start, tries it and describes the observed result.

You Do

Grade 3: Show a push or pull that changes the car's position. Grade 4: Identify a separable mixture and describe the sugar-water observation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, 3 plates, toy car, tray, dry beans, large pasta, clear cup, sugar, spoon. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only.

Social studies

2026-10-16 | Week 1 | People solve problems

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.9A

3.9A: Identify characteristics of good citizenship, including truthfulness, justice, equality, respect for oneself and others, responsibility in daily life, and participation in government by educating oneself about the issues, respectfully holding public officials to their word, and voting. In plain English: Recognize responsible citizenship, including honesty, fairness, respect and participation in government. Today: Show one example of responsibility with evidence.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.2A

4.2A: Summarize motivations for European exploration and settlement of Texas, including economic opportunity, competition, and the desire for expansion. In plain English: Explain why Europeans explored and settled Texas, including opportunity, competition and expansion. Today: Match an explorer, motivation and result.

I Do

Grade 3: Show one example of responsibility with evidence. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Match an explorer, motivation and result. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Work together with a second example from the same source set. G3 makes a symbol-and-meaning card. G4 places an explorer icon on a map and gives one oral/picture-supported reason. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Show one example of responsibility with evidence. Grade 4: Match an explorer, motivation and result. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources.